

Wearable computing devices to become common in five years

Wearable computing devices are expected to explode in popularity over the next year. With a wave of new gadgets set to hit the consumer market, these could become the norm for most people within five years—according to market researcher ABI Research.

ABI Research has forecast that the sales of wearable computing devices are set to grow to 485 million annually by 2018. Sports/activity trackers are widely available today, and their trendy and stylish appearance makes them very popular with a broad range of customers. These are expected to account for 61 per cent of the wearable technologies market in 2013. Smartphone-compatible watches are beginning to emerge, and Apple is expected to release a smart watch some time this year. Furthermore, the much-anticipated smart glasses will also arrive later this year.

Mobile phones to become largest consumer of Flash memory

Mobile phones are set to become the world's single largest consumer of

ASUS appoints new country manager for India

ASUS has appointed Peter Chang, regional head for South Asia, as the country manager for India. Chang would be responsible for planning and synchronising strategies of the company's System Business Products in India with those at the headquarter in Taiwan.

Flash memory in 2013—according to an IHS iSuppli report.

The report predicts that mobile phones will consume 24.6 per cent of all bits shipped this year, followed by solidstate drives at 23.3 per cent and memory cards at 19.7 per cent. These applications, along with USB drives, tablet PCs and MP3 players, will account for 93.2 per cent of Flash memory consumption.

With growing demand, IHS believes NAND Flash revenues to reach the record level of \$22 billion in 2013—up from \$20 billion in 2012.

99 per cent of all mobile threats target Android devices

According to the recently published Kaspersky Security Bulletin 2012,

Toshiba appoints Warke as country head for DS division

Toshiba India has appointed Sanjay Warke as the country head for its digital services (DS) division. Warke will develop, drive and implement business strategies and solutions for Toshiba India's DS division to maximise the company's business growth.

99 per cent of the newly discovered mobile malicious programs target the Android platform, with a very small amount targeting Java- and Symbian-based smartphones.

2012 was the second year to show explosive growth in Android malware. From a negligible eight new unique malicious programs in January 2011, the average monthly discovery rate for new Android malware in 2011 went up to more than 800 samples. In 2012 Kaspersky Lab identified an average of 6300 new mobile malware samples every month.

Overall, in 2012 the number of known malicious samples for Android increased more than eight times.

Indian ESDM industry to grow annually at 9.9 per cent from 2011 to 2015

According to the 6th ISA-Frost & Sullivan Report released recently, the performance of electronics system design and manufacturing (ESDM) sector over the last few years can be termed an achievement in view of the overall slowdown of the Indian economy. ESDM industry is expected to grow at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 9.9 per cent between 2011 and 2015, reaching an industry size of \$94.2 billion by 2015.

Dr Satya Gupta, chairman, ISA, said, "With growing market demand, world-class talent and favourable government policies, it is time for India to seize the



Nike's Fuel Band smart watch that resembles the shape of a wristband